



"Today there is consensus that India doesn't need a *mili-juli* sarkar. People have seen the lack of governance, appeasement politics, corruption and resultant instability. So the choice of the people in 2024 is for BJP"

"The BJP has been labelled as a party of only Brahmins and Banias, that it caters only to the Hindi heartland. However, in election after election we have proved these labels wrong"

a democracy, it is essential to provide opportunities to new generations and new blood. This democratic churn is what makes democracies vibrant. This churn is also what makes our party vibrant and keeps aspirations and hopes burning within our *karyakartas*. They feel that they too can rise in the party through their hard work. Our party is used to doing different experiments. In Gujarat, we opted for all fresh faces in ministries. In Delhi, we opted for all fresh faces in local corporation elections.

Q. The BJP is not ruling in any of the big southern and eastern states. What is the BJP gameplan to become a truly pan-Indian party?

This is an incorrect assessment, you are oversimplifying things. Since the time of the BJP's formation, we have been hearing such contrived opinions on who we are and who we represent. At times we were labelled a Brahmin-Bania party, at other times a party that caters to only the Hindi heartland. We were even labelled a party that has support only in the cities. However, in election after election, we've proven these labels wrong.

Q. In what way is it a wrong deduction?

Today, there is no corner of the country where our party does not have support. From local bodies in Kerala to being the principal opposition in many states, our party is doing robust work among the people. In Bihar, West Bengal, Odisha and Jharkhand, we are the principal opposition party. In Bihar, people had in fact given their overwhelming support and mandate to us. Six months back, we had a government in Karnataka. Even today, we have a government in Puducherry. We currently govern in 16 states and are the principal opposition in eight. From no presence in 2014, we are now in government in six Northeast states, including Christian-majority states like Nagaland and Meghalaya. Further, we are the single largest party as far as southern India is concerned, in terms of Lok Sabha seats. Consider our journey from a modest beginning of two Lok Sabha seats [in 1984] to 303 now. Could we have emerged as a significant force in national politics without the support and strength of the people from all parts of the country?